

tial transit delays can occur and hence a better, faster standard needs to be implemented.

In scenarios such as live Webcasts, where broadcast quality video is transmitted, GPRS will be of little use and a technology such as High Speed Circuit Switched Data (HSCSD) can be used in which the user can takeover up to four separate channels at the same time. In a technology such as HSCSD, transmission delays are less likely as there is an end-to-end connection between the sender and recipient. The downside to HSCSD is the high cost involved.

Due to these limitations, newer technologies are being looked upon and one of the most promising technologies is EDGE.

EDGE

The Enhanced Data Rates for GSM Evolution popularly known as EDGE is a new technology that delivers broadband-like data speeds to mobile handhelds. Using this technology, users can browse the Web on a mobile device at almost the same speeds as they would on a regular broadband connection on a desktop computer. Advanced mobile services such as video and music clips that are currently viewed on broadband connections can now be viewed using a mobile and also downloaded if needed.

EDGE can provide more than three times the data capacity over GPRS and network operators using EDGE can handle three times more users than GPRS. This is because EDGE enables GSM operators to offer higher speed mobile data services and serve more mobile data customers, and in the process free up GSM network capacities to accommodate additional voice traffic. Either way, it's a win-win situation.

EDGE is also known as EGPRS or Enhanced GPRS. This technology theoretically offers over 473.6 kbps and a dedicated capacity of 384 kbps (dependent on the networks and terminals used), ideal for video services and other multimedia.